

It is a scheme developed by the department to provide for the employment of Australian Government Authorised Officers (AAOs) by independent employment providers. Under the Scheme, agencies supply AAOs to Australian export slaughter establishments to meet EU standards.

Many countries accept product prepared to the Australian Standards, however where there are additional requirements, the department will develop programs to facilitate trade to those markets.

The European Union requires that post-mortem inspections are performed by inspectors employed by a party other than the food business operation. Therefore to export product to that market, AAOs must be sourced from an Independent AAO Employer.

AAOs can be employed by an export registered abattoir or labour hire provider (e.g. independent AAO employer).

For the EU market, AAOs must be employed by an independent AAO employer approved by the department to supply AAOs.

No. An AAO must be paid by the Independent AAO Employer at all times for whatever work they do at a meat establishment and cannot at any time work directly for or be paid by the meat establishment e.g. Not even in an off season.

The primary function is still to perform meat inspection activities. You may undertake other tasks reasonably considered to be associated with the meat inspection skills and role detailed in departmental work instructions. It may include such tasks as preparing material for inspection, trimming defects, ageing animals through dentition and disposing of inspected materials. Activities such as butchering or labouring are outside the scope of these associated activities and therefore would not be acceptable tasks to be performed by an AAO.

Information on the application process for AAOs, including the application form and the Independent Employer of AAOs Accreditation Scheme is available [on the department's website](#).

To find out more on this initiative including the AAO approval process, mandatory qualifications and how to contact an Independent AAO Employer, please visit the [Independent Employer of AAOs Accreditation Scheme](#) webpage on the department's website.

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